

Garden, of *The Pilgrim's Progress*, subtitled “a morality in a prologue and four acts,” was the culmination of nearly half a century of on-off work on the project. The summer of 1958 saw the first performance of the powerful Ninth Symphony. The night before Adrian Boult was due to conduct the new work's first recording, the composer died—leaving a legacy that is still sometimes derided as part of the so-called “English cowpat,” or pastoral, school of composers, but which continues to survive the musical world's fashion changes. Today, the range and scale of Vaughan Williams's achievement, which reach far beyond mere pastoralism, are appreciated more widely than ever before.

“ Ralph has been **dead for over 35 years** and **every year** has seemed **as long** as the **first.** ”

URSULA VAUGHAN WILLIAMS, SPEAKING OF HER
HUSBAND IN THE 1990s